

ASIAN EQUITY PERSPECTIVES

Into the home stretch

After a strong 1H rally, the AsiaPac regional index has corrected in 3QTD, with notable disparities across markets. Looking forward, **we retain our constructive core view on Asian equities**, anchored by a broadly supportive macro backdrop, strong tech-focused earnings growth, generally attractive valuations, and positioning that has reset from extended levels in selected markets. Key events and risks include the US midterm elections, higher US (and other market) bond yields, and continued tensions in the Middle East. **We retain our preference for North Asian markets**; key sectors including tech hardware, capital goods, banks, and healthcare; and themes including the AI hardware supply chain, defense, and shareholder returns. Given potential volatility into the US election and better seasonality thereafter, **we highlight derivative overlays for downside protection or upside exposure.**

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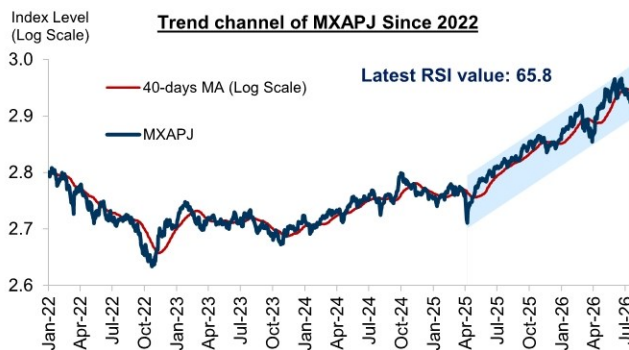
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1. Price context: at a tentative juncture

After a strong 1H rally, the AsiaPac regional index has corrected in 3QTD, with notable disparities across markets. Korea, the 1H outperformer, experienced the deepest drawdown, while 1H underperformers including China, India, and Indonesia rebounded as leadership rotated away from the dominant AI tech hardware theme. So far, the rebound in markets that saw the sharpest pullbacks has not been strong enough to suggest that uptrends are back in place. Equally, underperforming markets that recovered during the July rotation have not convincingly reversed course. At this tentative juncture, the key question for investors heading into the final stretch of the year is how markets will perform and how best to position into year-end. As discussed in the following sections, we remain constructive but note several risks, which we address through a number of implementation ideas.

Exhibit 1: The regional index is back in the middle of its trend channel after reaching the upper band on strong momentum at the end of 1H



Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: 3Q rotation: the strongest 1H performers have pulled back the most, while the weakest 1H markets have tended to rebound in July and August

Index	1H Return	3Q Return	YTD Return (Sorted)	YTD RSI (14)
MXAPJ	22.8%	0.1%	22.9%	57
MXAPJ ex-KR/TW	-7.9%	6.9%	-1.6%	58
By MSCI markets				
Korea	117.5%	-13.1%	89.0%	56
Taiwan	61.7%	-0.6%	60.7%	58
Singapore	6.8%	15.0%	22.7%	65
Thailand	21.7%	-0.6%	20.9%	47
Japan	14.7%	3.4%	18.6%	55
Australia	6.7%	6.8%	14.0%	65
Hong Kong	-3.1%	10.1%	6.7%	57
Malaysia	-1.4%	7.0%	5.5%	70
China-A (CSI300)	10.5%	-6.9%	3.0%	41
Philippines	-0.6%	2.7%	2.1%	39
China (MXCN)	-15.9%	8.3%	-8.9%	53
India	-10.4%	1.3%	-9.2%	52
Indonesia	-43.8%	13.7%	-36.1%	56

Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

2. Constructive core view: Macro backdrop

Our core regional equity market view remains constructive, which is why we expect the regional index to break out of its current trading range once risk appetite rebuilds. This view is based on four pillars: macro, earnings, valuation, and positioning.

The macro backdrop can be summarized as fairly positive for equities. First, GDP growth is tracking broadly in line with trend levels across major regions, with global GDP growth likely to improve from 2.5% in 2026 to 2.8% next year. Second, a moderate monetary policy tightening cycle is underway in the AsiaPac region, but not to an extent that threatens growth or equity market valuations. Moreover, our economists maintain a more dovish-than-consensus view on the Fed and expect two rate cuts in 2027, which should ease pressure on regional central banks. Third, we expect moderate Asian FX appreciation vs. USD over the next 12 months, which has historically been supportive of Asian equity market performance. Finally, our Oil analysts' base-case view is for Brent crude to moderate from the current high-\$80/bbl level to US\$75/bbl in 2027, which is also fundamentally supportive for the region.

Exhibit 3: A fairly favorable macro growth outlook

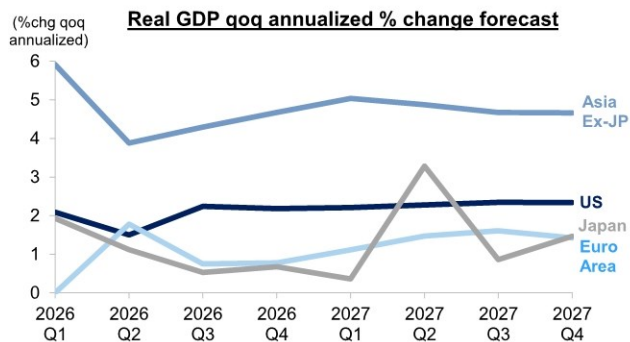
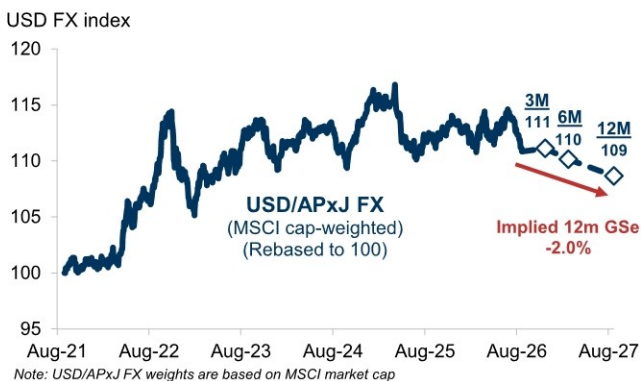


Exhibit 4: Moderate, but not excessive, policy tightening

Markets	GS Monetary policy outlook for US, EU and APAC markets							
	2026				2027			
	Q1	Q2	Q3F	Q4F	Q1F	Q2F	Q3F	Q4F
US					-25 bps	-25 bps	-25 bps	-25 bps
Euro area		+25 bps	+25 bps		-25 bps	-25 bps	-25 bps	-25 bps
Japan		+25 bps	+25 bps		+25 bps		+25 bps	
China					-10 bps			
India				+25 bps	+25 bps			
Korea			+50 bps		+25 bps			
Taiwan								
Indonesia		+100 bps	+25 bps	+25 bps				
Malaysia								
Thailand	-25 bps							
Philippines	-25 bps	+50 bps	+25 bps	+50 bps				
Australia	+50 bps	+25 bps		+25 bps			-25 bps	-25 bps

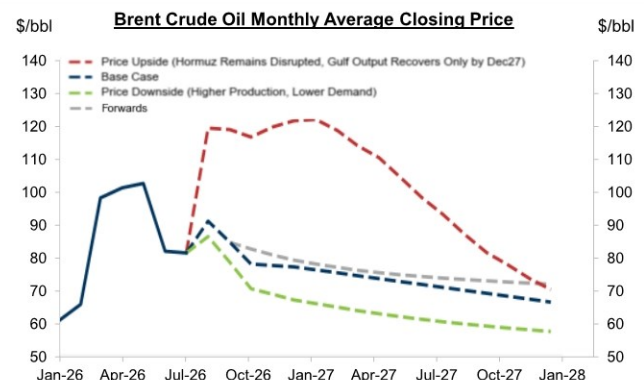
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Asian equities typically perform well when Asian currencies appreciate versus the USD



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Our base case is for moderately lower oil prices into 2027



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

3. Constructive core view: Earnings

The most compelling argument supporting a positive view on regional equities is the exceptionally strong profit growth generated by markets with high exposure to the tech hardware supply chain. We have raised our profit growth forecasts again and now expect earnings growth of 350% and 60% in Korea and Taiwan this year, followed by a further 35% and 30%, respectively, in 2027. This brings regional earnings growth to 72% and 23% for 2026 and 2027, broadly in line with the consensus aggregate forecast, albeit with some notable differences at the individual market level. Strong 1QFY26 results in Japan have also prompted us to raise our FY26 earnings growth forecast to 19% from 13%. Of note, ERLI, our earnings revision lead indicator that we publish at the start of each month, has provided consistent guidance on the direction and magnitude of consensus sell-side earnings revisions. It continues to signal a moderate pace of upgrades.

Zooming out, the AsiaPac region is delivering robust profit growth following an extended period of sub-par earnings performance. As we examined in two global strategy papers (see [here](#) and [here](#)), regional earnings grew at a modest 6% CAGR from 2011 to 2025, well below the mid-teens growth rates recorded during the previous two decades. This helps explain the region's weak performance of just 3% annual returns over that period. Even with regional earnings growth moderating to 13% in 2028 (our current expectation), the 2026-2028 CAGR would still be 34%, which supports a positive view on equity performance both in absolute terms and relative to other global regions.

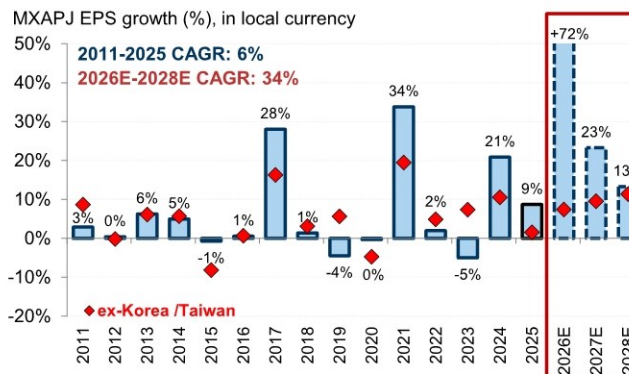
Exhibit 7: The earnings growth outlook for Asia remains strong into 2027

EPS Growth	Consensus			GS		GS (OLD*)	
Markets	2025	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E
Australia	3%	5%	4%	4%	5%	6%	5%
China	-1%	17%	17%	8%	12%	8%	12%
China-A	5%	27%	16%	20%	13%	20%	13%
Hong Kong	1%	18%	5%	16%	5%	16%	7%
India	12%	11%	16%	10%	13%	10%	13%
Indonesia	-4%	1%	10%	0%	8%	1%	8%
Korea	35%	340%	35%	350%	35%	320%	35%
Malaysia	0%	9%	6%	8%	8%	8%	8%
Philippines	13%	1%	10%	0%	8%	0%	8%
Singapore	0%	10%	10%	12%	10%	6%	8%
Taiwan	23%	58%	28%	62%	30%	48%	30%
Thailand	12%	15%	4%	16%	4%	8%	6%
MXAPJ	9%	72%	24%	72%	23%	60%	22%
Japan* (CY)	11%	18%	12%	17%	12%	11%	11%

Note: Light blue (vs. grey) shaded numbers indicate upward (vs. downward) revisions vs. GS OLD (as of Jun 29)

Source: FactSet, I/B/E/S, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: The region is delivering robust profit growth after a prolonged period of subpar earnings performance



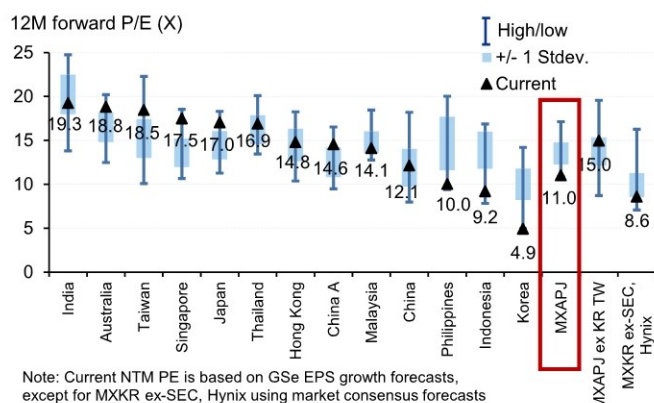
Source: FactSet, Bloomberg, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

4. Constructive core view: Valuation

Market pricing of the strong regional growth backdrop is generally fair to very attractive in selected areas. At the aggregate level, the MXAPJ Index trades at 11.1x 12-month forward P/E (-2 s.d.) and 2.6x P/B relative to a record-high 19.9% ROE. However, this is distorted by Korea's very low valuation, with the market trading at just 5x forward earnings. Several smaller ASEAN markets, notably Indonesia and the Philippines, also trade at low multiples (9-10x), as does offshore China (12x). At the other end of the spectrum, India, Australia, Taiwan, Japan, and Singapore all trade at roughly 18-20x forward earnings, which is high in both absolute terms and relative to their respective historical ranges. This highlights the need for a more differentiated stance across regional markets, which informs our allocation views.

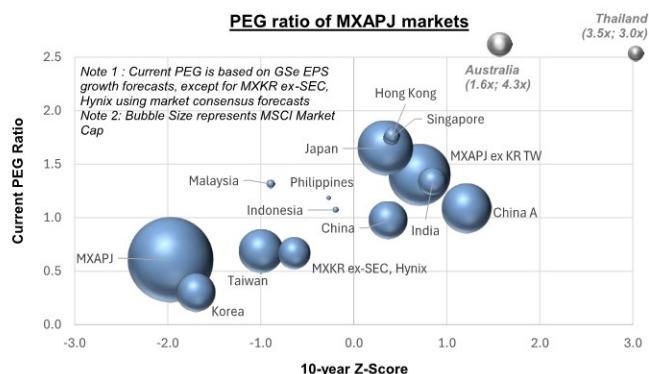
However, equity market valuations must also be considered in the context of growth. We therefore evaluate markets on a P/E-to-growth (PEG) basis and assess how they compare with their respective historical ranges. **Regional valuations generally appear compelling on PEG metrics, both in absolute terms and on a z-score basis.**

Exhibit 9: Aggregate regional valuation is low, albeit with wide variation between markets



Source: FactSet, I/B/E/S, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: Most regional markets look attractive on a P/E-to-growth basis, both in absolute and z-score terms



Source: FactSet, I/B/E/S, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

5. Constructive core view: Positioning

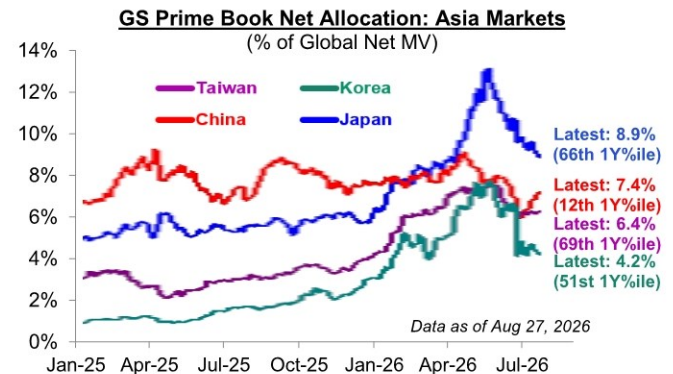
Aggregate foreign investor positioning has reduced across EM Asia ex-China, and notable pockets of excessive retail leverage, such as Korea, have derisked to a meaningful extent. **We therefore judge positioning across most markets to be cleaner, which also supports a constructive investment stance.** First, daily exchange-level net foreign transaction data for the 8 emerging Asian markets that provide such information show cumulative YTD net selling of more than US\$170bn, by far the largest outflows on record, led by Korea and with substantial outflows from Taiwan and India. Second, active EM/AEJ funds are underweight many Asian markets, notably Taiwan, India, and Korea. Third, hedge fund net allocations to Japan, Korea, Taiwan, and China have all declined from record-high levels (ex-China) to mid-range levels on a one-year lookback basis (12th percentile for China). Fourth, Korea leveraged ETF AUM and daily dealer procyclical hedging have fallen 50-70% from their late-June peak levels. Taken together, these data points point to a more balanced positioning and risk appetite backdrop compared with the extended conditions seen at the end of 1H26.

Exhibit 11: EM Asia ex-China markets have experienced substantial net foreign investor selling in 2026



Source: Bloomberg, Respective Local Stock Exchanges

Exhibit 12: Hedge fund net positioning in the major North Asian markets has reduced sharply in 3Q



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities

6. Risks: US midterms, higher bond yields, geopolitics

While our baseline investment stance is positive for the reasons we have enumerated above, we also recognize **several macro risks that could challenge market performance in the final stretch of the year, including the US midterm elections, higher bond yields, and a potential rise in geopolitical risk.**

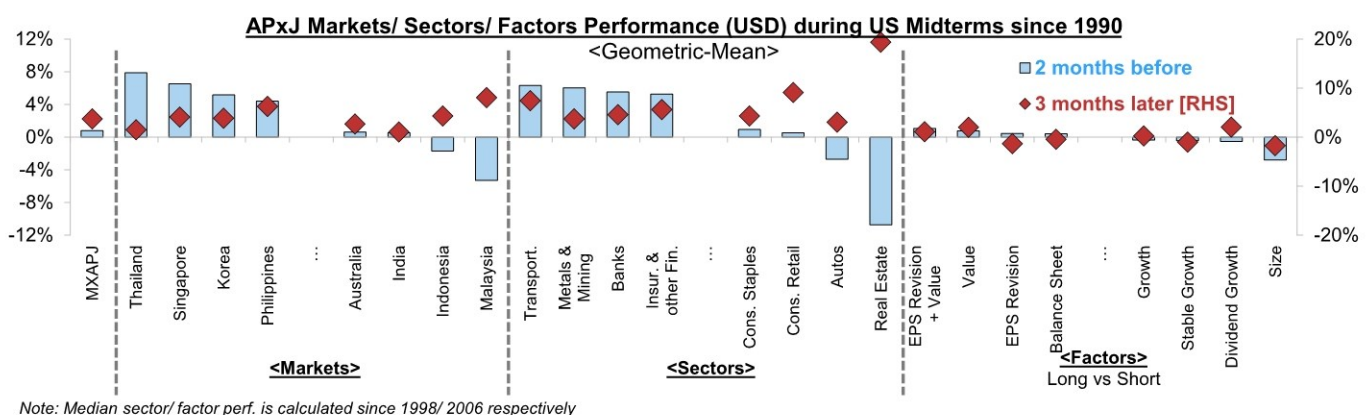
The US midterm elections will be held on November 3, roughly two months from now and near the midpoint of the remaining period to year-end. Our US strategy team has shown that policy uncertainty and S&P 500 volatility typically rise ahead of midterm elections. These tend to moderate after the elections, leading the equity market to trade sideways beforehand and rally thereafter. We have conducted a similar analysis for the MXAPJ Index (although with a shorter data set) and find that the region also tends to range trade in the two months leading up to the election and rally during the subsequent three months. The region typically enjoys positive seasonality in the fourth quarter, but returns in midterm election years have been somewhat stronger than usual. This informs our view on the index path and implementation strategies, as discussed later.

Concerns about higher US Treasury yields have recently increased, fanned by the nearly 40bp rise in 10-year yields since early July and renewed focus on persistently high US budget deficits (6% of GDP). While our interest rate strategists expect the 10-year yield to decline from the current 4.7% range, a move to or through the 5% level would be challenging for markets, particularly longer-duration sectors. Our regional macro model, which controls for growth and commodity prices, shows that sensitivity to higher US rates is negative across all MXAPJ constituent markets.

Important measures of risk, notably the US VIX (CBOE Volatility Index), the US Economic Policy Uncertainty Index, and the Global Geopolitical Risk Index, have all moderated and are near the lower end of their historical ranges. This indicates a meaningful degree of complacency and, therefore, potential equity market vulnerability should geopolitical risks resurface or US policy uncertainty and market volatility increase, as has historically been the case in the lead-up to midterm elections.

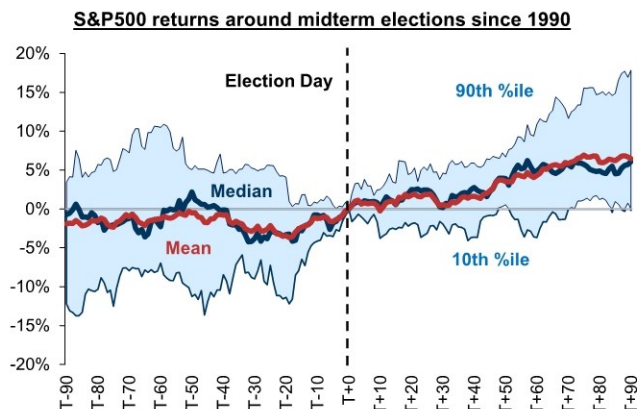
In addition to these macro risks, key events to monitor into year-end include corporate earnings results, central bank policy meetings, and capital market activity.

Exhibit 13: Asian regional equity markets have typically been range-bound ahead of US midterm elections and rallied during the subsequent three months



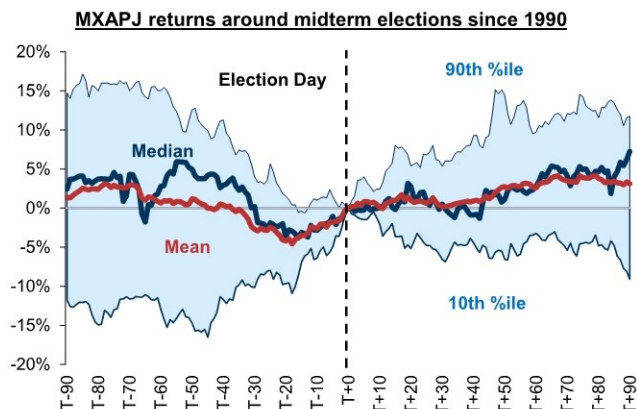
Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: US equities have typically traded sideways ahead of midterm elections and regained traction afterward



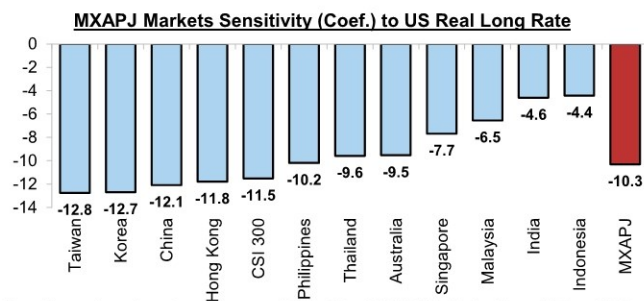
Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: The MXAPJ Index has shown a pattern similar to that of the S&P 500 around US midterm elections



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

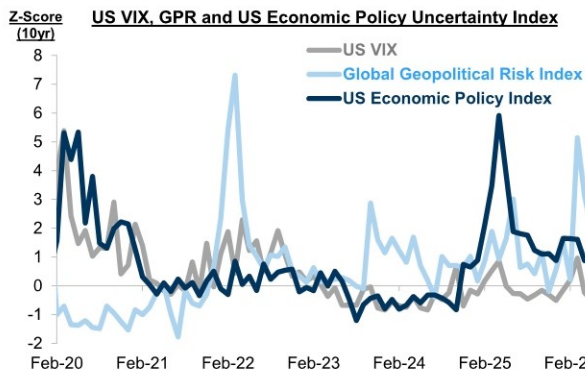
Exhibit 16: Asian equity markets tend to trade down when US real long-term rates rise



Note: The results are based on a 5-factor model with China CAI, US CAI, US Real Rate, GSCI and GPR (rolling 3M changes over the past 10 yrs, excluding the Covid period) as the independent variables and the market index USD price returns (3M) as the dependent variables.

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: Key measures of risk are near the lower end of their historical ranges



Source: Caldara, Dario and Matteo Iacoviello, Haver, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: Events to monitor into year-end include earnings results, central bank policy meetings, geopolitics, elections, and capital market activity
Calendar

Month	Market	Local or multinational events/Elections/Government changes and meetings
2026 H2		
Sep - Oct		
Sep 12-13	India	18th BRICS Summit (India)
Sep 15 - 16	USA	FOMC Meeting with Summary of Economic Projections
Sep 18	Japan	BOJ Meeting
Sep 18 - 22	ASEAN	58th ASEAN Economic Ministerial Meetings
Sep 24	China/USA	President Xi's planned state visit to the USA (Trump-Xi Summit)
Oct 12 -18	Global	2026 IMF/World Bank Group Annual Meetings (Thailand)
Oct 27 - 28	USA	FOMC Meeting
Oct 30	Japan	BOJ Meeting
Oct - Nov	Asia Pacific	3Q earnings reporting season
Nov - Dec		
Nov 3	USA	2026 United States State Legislative Election
Nov 3	USA	2026 United States Senate Elections
Nov 3	USA	2026 United States House of Representatives Elections
Nov 3	USA	2026 United States Gubernatorial Elections
Nov 11	USA	Expiration of tariff/rare earth control pause agreed at Trump-Xi meeting in South Korea
Nov 18-19	Asia Pacific	2026 APEC Economic Leaders' Meeting (China)
Nov 28	Taiwan	2026 Taiwan Local Election
Nov (TBC)	Global	MSCI Index Review
Nov (TBC)	Global	CPTPP Commission Meeting (Vietnam)
Dec 8 - 9	USA	FOMC Meeting with Summary of Economic Projections
Dec 14 - 15	Global	21st G20 Summit (Miami)
Dec 18	Japan	BOJ Meeting
Dec	China	Central Economic Work Conference
Dec	China	Politburo meeting on economic policies

Note: Elections related to changes in government are shaded in blue.

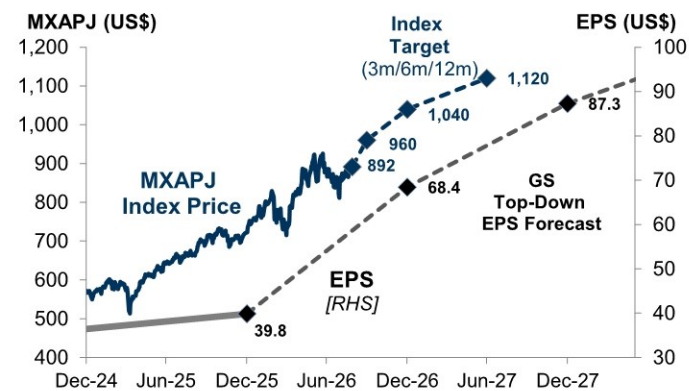
Source: Respective Central Banks & Government Offices, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

7. Strong, albeit concentrated, expected regional returns

We raise our 12m MXAPJ Index target by 4%, from 1,080 to 1,120, based on higher earnings and a target P/E of 11.9x (previously 12.2x). This implies potential USD price returns of 26%, led by Korea and Taiwan. Excluding these two tech-driven markets, our forecasts imply 8% and 11% price and total returns, respectively. Individual market return estimates are driven largely by the earnings trajectory, with some valuation compression in markets that currently trade at more elevated valuations and valuation recovery in those where valuations remain depressed.

Our 3m and 6m targets are now 960 and 1,040, respectively. We have revised down our 3m target to reflect near-term uncertainty around the US elections, followed by a potential late-4Q rally.

Exhibit 19: Our 1,120 12-month MXAPJ target implies a 25% USD price return, driven by continued strong earnings growth



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

8. Allocations: North Asia and tech focus, with selective broadening

We maintain our overweight stance on the tech hardware-heavy North Asian markets of Korea, Taiwan, Japan, and China A, funded by underweights in Australia and parts of ASEAN. Sectorally, we continue to emphasize tech hardware & semis, capital goods, banks (ex-AU/CN), and healthcare, funded by autos, software, and defensives. YTD, our market and sector tilts have outperformed by 12pp and 48pp, respectively.

Our positive view on **Korea** rests on: (a) our view that the semiconductor memory and broader AI tech hardware cycle is likely to be stronger and last longer than previous cycles, given accelerating compute demand and deep supply shortages potentially extending to 2030; (b) cleaner positioning following the decline in leveraged ETF AUM; (c) attractive themes and rapid growth in the non-memory part of the market; and (d) favorable market risk/reward given 2026–2028 earnings growth of 350%/35%/20% and a 5x forward P/E. Many of the arguments for Korea also apply to **Taiwan**, which has a deeper listed hardware/semis supply chain but trades at a higher valuation. We recently raised earnings forecasts and targets for **Japan** and remain constructive, given a number of attractive thematic opportunities, including domestic reflation, defense, the AI supply chain, and corporate reform.

Onshore **China A**-shares continue to deliver strong earnings (+17% yoy in 2Q26), sector weights tilt toward favored themes, including 15th Five-Year Plan beneficiaries, and shareholder returns continue to improve, supported by regulatory policy. While we remain OW A-shares and MW offshore **China**, we advocate selectively increasing exposure to H-shares, either in the internet/soft tech sector, where earnings momentum may recover in 3Q–4Q, or in non-AI segments such as healthcare. This broadening of exposure also extends to **India**, where macro activity and earnings are stabilizing and entry points in banks, energy refiners, TMT, defense, and utilities appear favorable. Soft earnings growth and elevated valuations keep us cautious on **Australia**, while several ASEAN markets, including **Indonesia**, **Philippines**, and **Thailand**, have subdued return prospects given varying combinations of low earnings growth, valuations, diminished liquidity, and index free-float overhangs.

Exhibit 20: We remain overweight North Asia and underweight Australia and much of ASEAN

GS Strategy APxJ Market Allocation

	Market	Index	Index Level	GS 12m Target	Target fPE	z-score (10yr)	Chg to Target	USD Total Return
OW	Korea	KOSPI	6,818	12,000	7.5x	-1.4	76%	79%
	China A	CSI300	4,626	5,500	15.5x	+1.8	19%	24%
	Taiwan	TWSE	46,412	54,000	17.5x	+1.0	16%	20%
	Japan	TPX	4,156	4,600	17.6x	+2.5	11%	16%
MW	China	MXCN	76	85	12.2x	+0.2	11%	14%
	Singapore	FSSTI	5,699	6,100	17.2x	+2.2	7%	13%
	Malaysia	FBMKL	1,730	1,820	13.6x	-0.9	5%	12%
	Hong Kong	MXHK	16,086	17,200	14.8x	+0.2	7%	11%
	India	NIFTY	24,178	26,500	18.8x	-0.6	10%	9%
UW	Philippines	PCOMP	5,946	6,200	9.8x	-1.6	4%	8%
	Thailand	SET	1,591	1,650	16.8x	+0.3	4%	8%
	Australia	AS51	9,080	9,200	18.5x	+1.2	1%	6%
	Indonesia	JCI	6,549	6,300	8.3x	-2.6	(4%)	1%
	MXAPJ (USD)		892	1,120	11.9x	-1.3	26%	28%

Note (1): 12m index targets are as of Jun-2027; Return for MXAPJ is in USD terms

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 21: We favor North Asia and AI-related tech hardware exposure; key themes include HALO, energy security, defense, and shareholder returns

Summary Views	
Returns & Growth (MXAPJ)	12m index target: 1120, implying 26%/28% USD price/total return; GSe path (3/6/12m): 960/1040/1120; 72%/23% EPSg in 2026/27
Markets	OW Japan, Korea, China A, Taiwan MW Singapore, Hong Kong, Malaysia, India, China Offshore UW Australia, Thailand, Indonesia, Philippines
Sectors	OW Tech H/W & Semis, Capital Goods, Health Care, Ex-AU/CN Banks MW Internet/Media/Entertainment, Insurance & Other Fins, Property, Chemicals, Metals & Mining, Telecom Services, Consumer Retail & Durables, AU/CN Banks, Energy UW Transportation, Software & Services, Utilities, Autos, Cons Staples
Themes & Implementation Ideas	AI Beneficiaries: Infrastructure (Servers, Hardware, Semis) HALO (Heavy Assets, Low Obsolescence): Capital Intensive vs. Light Power Demand: Nuclear Power, Renewables, Power & Electricity Geopolitics: U.S. Reindustrialization, Aerospace & Defense Space Economy: Asia Space Opportunities Revision Momentum: Consensus Revision Winners, Strong EPS Revisions China Opportunities: 15th FYP Portfolio, Going Global, China AI/Growth Shareholder Yield: Secure Dividend, Buyback

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

9. Implementation

We have three implementation ideas for the final stretch of the year. First, entry points for our **top regional themes** have improved following the 3Q pullback. These include AIGC semis, aerospace & defense, energy security, HALO (heavy asset, low obsolescence), and high shareholder yield.

Second, we feature two screens: (a) **AI tech hardware stocks with low PEG ratios**, which offer exposure to the growth opportunity from the extended tech cycle in a disciplined manner; and (b) **GS Buy-rated stocks with strong shareholder returns**, high FCF yields, and positive earnings revisions. The objective of the latter screen is to highlight stocks that may be less volatile and more defensive in the lead-up to the US midterm elections, while still offering attractive growth and valuation characteristics (median 12x 2027 P/E and 15% EPS CAGR for 2026-27).

Third, we present a range of **derivative implementation ideas** for Korea, Japan, and China focused on downside protection and upside participation. For **Korea**, high volatility makes put-spread collars and put-funded call spreads attractive; all of the suggested structures are zero cost. For **Japan**, lower volatility makes European puts and calls attractive, as they provide ways to hedge downside risk or participate in upside gains with low upfront premiums. In the **China A-share** market, funding for a long CSI 300 swap is at record-high levels (650bp annualized), which is highly attractive. This can be used to create a USD-quanto structure that provides asymmetric 3.4x upside versus 1.0x downside participation. Alternatively, the premium can be used to fund downside protection in a floored swap at close to par for the cost of SOFR.

Exhibit 22: Recent pullbacks offer better entry points for our top regional themes

Basket Performance since 2025 (rebased to 100)



Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 23: Derivative implementation ideas

Market	Downside Protection	Upside Participation
Korea	Put-Spread Collar (PSvC) 10 Dec 2026: 95% / 75% puts, 111% call; zero cost; -64% delta 11 Mar 2027: 95% / 72% puts, 113% call; zero cost; -65% delta	Put-Funded Call Spread (CSvP) 10 Dec 2026: 105% / 125% calls, 90% put; zero cost; 55% delta 11 Mar 2027: 105% / 130% calls, 85% put; zero cost; 50% delta
	(European Put) 11 Dec 2026: 90% strike; 2.51% premium; 30.61 IV; -21.2% delta 12 Mar 2027: 85% strike; 2.79% premium; 30.59 IV; -16.7% delta	(European Call) 11 Dec 2026: 110% strike; 2.23% premium; 26.75 IV; 23.6% delta 12 Mar 2027: 115% strike; 2.75% premium; 25.86 IV; 22.5% delta
China	(USD-Floored Swap) 17 Sep 2027: GSCB300P; 99.45% floor; investor pays SOFR	(Long Swap) Own CSI 300; receive 650 bp annualized carry (USD-Quanto Participation) Sep 2027: GSCB300P; 3.4x upside and 1.0x downside participation

Note: Pricing and Greeks are indicative as of 27-Aug and are subject to change.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 24: AI tech hardware/semis stocks with low PEG ratios among the peer group, which offer exposure to the growth opportunity from the extended tech cycle in a disciplined manner

BBG Ticker	Company Name	Market	AI-related Business	>US\$1bn >US\$10mn		<33%ile within AI peer group					
				Size and Liquidity		Valuations					
				Listed Market Cap (US\$mnn)	6M ADVT (US\$mnn)	2027E P/E (X)	2026E P/B (X)	2026E EPS Growth (%)	2027E EPS Growth (%)	2027E ROE (%)	PEG Ratio (NTM PE / STM EPSg)
Asia AI Capex / Infrastructure Stocks with Lower PEG Ratio among AI Business Peer Group											
285A JT	Kioxia Holdings	Japan	Memory IDMs	180,711	13,375	4	5.8	765	62	89	0.16
6981 JT	Murata Manufacturing	Japan	Passive Components & MLCCs	90,055	1,224	29	4.7	38	43	15	0.80
4004 JT	Resonac Holdings	Japan	Advanced Packaging Materials & Films	19,665	299	21	3.9	254	36	17	0.76
4188 JT	Mitsubishi Chemical	Japan	Advanced Packaging Materials & Films	10,595	46	12	0.9	392	38	7	0.71
6976 JT	Taiyo Yuden	Japan	Passive Components & MLCCs	7,685	1,324	26	3.1	118	67	11	0.49
3436 JT	SUMCO	Japan	Front-End Materials & Chemicals	7,548	328	41	2.2	-	-	5	0.28
4005 JT	Sumitomo Chemical	Japan	Front-End Materials & Chemicals	5,826	44	10	0.9	34	22	8	0.90
6871 JT	Micronics Japan	Japan	Wafer Fab Equipment (WFE) OEMs	3,336	104	17	6.2	98	25	32	0.65
6590 JT	Shibaura Mechatronics	Japan	Wafer Fab Equipment (WFE) OEMs	1,802	63	16	4.2	21	31	24	0.41
005930 KP	Samsung Electronics	Korea	Memory IDMs	1,126,402	5,203	4	2.5	621	45	51	0.30
000660 KP	SK Hynix	Korea	Memory IDMs	915,364	6,244	4	3.3	499	30	63	0.24
222800 KQ	Simmtech	Korea	Substrate & Carrier Manufacturers	3,490	60	14	6.3	-	69	38	0.39
403870 KQ	HPSP	Korea	Wafer Fab Equipment (WFE) OEMs	3,010	144	24	10.6	71	37	38	0.74
489790 KP	Hanwha Vision	Korea	Wafer Fab Equipment (WFE) OEMs	1,887	28	11	2.6	245	58	22	0.37
2330 TT	TSMC	Taiwan	Pure-Play Foundries	1,972,728	2,490	17	8.2	63	31	40	0.66
2454 TT	MediaTek	Taiwan	Fabless & IP Designers	195,674	1,200	28	14.2	4	102	44	0.34
2308 TT	Delta Electronics	Taiwan	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	145,126	734	28	13.0	76	58	40	0.55
2317 TT	Hon Hai Precision	Taiwan	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	111,590	541	11	1.8	35	22	16	0.55
2383 TT	Elite Material	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	62,208	382	25	25.9	183	91	76	0.47
3037 TT	Unimicron Technology	Taiwan	Substrate & Carrier Manufacturers	59,181	677	30	14.4	375	88	41	0.49
2408 TT	Nanya Technology	Taiwan	Memory IDMs	58,918	1,212	6	4.3	2,864	37	52	0.22
1303 TT	Nan Ya Plastics	Taiwan	Advanced Packaging Materials & Films	56,952	361	15	4.5	2,096	25	30	0.64
6669 TT	Wiwynn	Taiwan	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	39,977	312	13	7.8	34	49	51	0.44
2345 TT	Accton Technology	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	37,018	274	18	12.9	82	36	56	0.45
7769 TT	Hon. Precision	Taiwan	Wafer Fab Equipment (WFE) OEMs	36,037	168	29	16.3	72	69	47	0.48
2327 TT	Yageo Corporation	Taiwan	Passive Components & MLCCs	36,066	938	17	5.6	69	70	29	0.36
2344 TT	Winbond Electronics	Taiwan	Memory IDMs	26,420	885	4	3.8	2,728	102	68	0.22
8046 TT	Nan Ya PCB	Taiwan	Substrate & Carrier Manufacturers	26,413	506	28	15.2	485	160	46	0.38
3231 TT	Wistron	Taiwan	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	18,018	291	8	2.5	97	41	29	0.25
2368 TT	Gold Circuit Electronics	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	17,002	255	16	10.9	117	60	55	0.35
4958 TT	Zhen Ding Technology	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	16,822	542	19	3.4	102	80	17	0.36
6223 TT	MPI	Taiwan	Wafer Fab Equipment (WFE) OEMs	15,742	200	38	28.2	90	111	57	0.53
3189 TT	Kinsus Interconnect Tech	Taiwan	Substrate & Carrier Manufacturers	15,202	422	35	10.5	228	137	27	0.38
6274 TT	Taiwan Union Technology	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	13,659	270	20	15.7	213	94	63	0.29
6488 TT	GlobalWafers	Taiwan	Front-End Materials & Chemicals	14,458	223	30	4.6	38	52	15	0.51
3661 TT	Alchip Technologies	Taiwan	Fabless & IP Designers	10,539	277	22	6.4	101	25	27	0.50
2449 TT	King Yuan Electronics	Taiwan	OSAT & Packaging Specialists	10,030	290	18	5.1	45	57	26	0.47
3044 TT	Tripod Technology	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	7,980	65	12	3.9	60	29	30	0.46
6515 TT	WinWay Technology	Taiwan	OSAT & Packaging Specialists	6,945	102	31	28.0	99	115	72	0.41
8996 TT	Kaori Heat Treatment	Taiwan	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	3,866	108	31	22.1	148	91	58	0.40
3324 TT	AURAS Technology	Taiwan	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	3,114	121	14	6.6	95	35	40	0.57
3363 TT	FOCI Fiber Optic Communications	Taiwan	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	2,525	81	42	30.4	28	8,156	56	0.24
300308 C2	Zhongji Innolight (A)	China A	Fabless & IP Designers	143,077	4,560	16	15.3	209	76	66	0.33
300502 C2	Eoptolink Technology (A)	China A	Fabless & IP Designers	84,892	3,534	18	16.1	125	49	65	0.38
002475 C2	Luxshare Precision (A)	China A	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	62,337	1,653	15	3.9	23	34	23	0.53
300476 C2	Victory Giant Technology (A)	China A	High-Speed PCBs & Interconnects	33,872	1,909	16	6.2	72	89	33	0.37
601231 C1	Universal Scientific Industrial (Shanghai) (A)	China A	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	9,795	232	19	3.0	13	49	15	0.53
688099 C1	Amlogic (Shanghai) (A)	China A	Fabless & IP Designers	5,772	231	19	4.4	70	35	22	0.67
300602 C2	Shenzhen FRD Science & Technology (A)	China A	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	3,888	164	26	5.7	74	57	20	0.52
992 HK	Lenovo	China Offshore	AI Server Systems & Infrastructure	48,610	368	11	5.3	53	80	41	0.26
Median				17,510	305	17.7	5.8	96	57	38	0.45
Screen Aggregate				5,807,339	55,371						

Note: Valuations and earnings growth forecasts are based on I/B/E/S estimates. Pricing as of Aug 27, 2026.

Source: FactSet, I/B/E/S, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 25: GS Buy-rated stocks with strong shareholder returns, high FCF yields, and positive earnings revisions

BBG Ticker	Company Name	Market	GICS Sub-Industry	Quoted Price	>US\$3bn >US\$5mn		>4% Combined		>5% (non-Fins/Prop)		>0%				B/B*	
					Size and Liquidity		Shareholder Yield			Valuations / Earnings						
					Listed Market Cap (US\$mn)	6M ADVT (US\$mn)	2026E Dividend Yield (%)	LTM / YTD Ann. Buyback Yield (%)	2026E FCF Yield (%)	2027E P/E (X)	2026E P/B (X)	2026E EPS Growth (%)	2027E EPS Growth (%)	2027 EPS Revision (3M, %)		
GS APAC Buy-Rated Stocks with High Shareholder Returns and FCF Yields																
7203 JT	Toyota Motor	Japan	Automobile Manufacturers	JPY	3077	281,878	502	3.2%	11.6%	9%	9.2	1.0	(3)	11	0%	B
285A JT	Kioxia Holdings	Japan	Semiconductors	JPY	52500	180,711	13,375	1.1%	8.4%	12%	4.2	5.8	765	62	57%	B
8316 JT	Sumitomo Mitsui Financial	Japan	Diversified Banks	JPY	6794	162,094	495	2.6%	1.9%	-	13.4	1.6	19	11	4%	B
6758 JT	Sony Group	Japan	Consumer Electronics	JPY	3870	144,902	424	0.8%	6.3%	6%	17.1	2.6	17	10	2%	B
8411 JT	Mizuho Financial	Japan	Diversified Banks	JPY	8340	127,876	450	1.8%	3.0%	-	12.9	1.7	22	14	8%	B*
8001 JT	Itochu	Japan	Trading Companies & Distributors	JPY	2105	104,701	176	2.1%	3.7%	5%	14.4	2.2	8	7	2%	B
6178 JT	JAPAN POST	Japan	Life & Health Insurance	JPY	2425	42,743	72	2.4%	4.7%	-	12.2	0.7	13	38	10%	B
6702 JT	Fujitsu	Japan	IT Consulting & Other Services	JPY	3753	40,983	185	1.4%	6.3%	5%	19.0	3.1	(11)	(0)	3%	B
5016 JT	JX Advanced Metals	Japan	Diversified Metals & Mining	JPY	3792	22,592	736	0.9%	6.0%	6%	19.6	4.6	58	18	9%	B
6326 JT	Kubota	Japan	Agricultural & Farm Machinery	JPY	2839	20,291	71	1.8%	3.6%	5%	13.0	1.2	49	(11)	7%	B
8697 JT	Japan Exchange Group	Japan	Financial Exchanges & Data	JPY	2284.5	14,795	49	3.2%	4.6%	-	22.7	6.8	28	8	17%	B
3407 JT	Asahi Kasei	Japan	Commodity Chemicals	JPY	1649	14,136	57	2.6%	1.6%	6%	12.2	1.0	10	10	3%	B
7186 JT	Yokohama Financial	Japan	Regional Banks	JPY	1912	13,737	38	2.4%	2.8%	-	13.2	1.5	32	24	15%	B
8953 JT	Japan Metropolitan Fund Investment	Japan	Retail REITs	JPY	117000	5,282	13	5.0%	-	-	19.6	1.3	4	(4)	6%	B
8804 JT	Tokyo Tatemono	Japan	Diversified Real Estate Activities	JPY	3427	4,474	21	3.7%	0.4%	-	10.2	1.1	12	6	3%	B
CPU AT	Computershare	Australia	Data Processing & Outsourced Services	AUD	39.03	16,234	37	3.8%	0.5%	5%	17.6	6.7	(3)	4	4%	B
5 HK	HSBC Holdings	Hong Kong	Diversified Banks	HKD	161.8	354,309	276	4.1%	-	-	11.0	2.0	13	11	1%	B
1299 HK	AIA Group	Hong Kong	Life & Health Insurance	HKD	74.65	98,525	326	2.9%	2.2%	-	11.9	2.1	24	10	3%	B
2388 HK	BOC Hong Kong	Hong Kong	Diversified Banks	HKD	49.82	67,191	73	4.6%	-	-	11.5	1.4	5	9	5%	B
2888 HK	Standard Chartered	Hong Kong	Diversified Banks	HKD	233.2	64,991	30	2.6%	7.9%	-	10.8	1.4	5	18	2%	B
12 HK	Henderson Land Devel.	Hong Kong	Real Estate Development	HKD	29.2	18,033	35	4.3%	-	-	15.0	0.4	36	16	8%	B*
19 HK	Swire Pacific	Hong Kong	Industrial Conglomerates	HKD	105.4	10,473	13	4.0%	-	5%	10.9	0.5	11	4	10%	B
1128 HK	Wynn Macau	Hong Kong	Casinos & Gaming	HKD	5.715	3,838	5	7.8%	-	13%	10.1	-	66	10	1%	B
DBS SP	DBS Group	Singapore	Diversified Banks	SGD	75.65	169,226	248	4.4%	-	-	17.1	3.0	6	9	6%	B
KDCREIT SP	Keppel DC REIT	Singapore	Data Center REITs	SGD	2.21	4,255	21	5.0%	-	-	18.4	1.3	8	1	6%	B
939 HK	CCB (H)	China Offshore	Diversified Banks	HKD	9.135	280,151	273	5.1%	-	-	5.5	0.5	8	8	3%	B
3988 HK	Bank of China	China Offshore	Diversified Banks	HKD	5.505	58,721	144	5.0%	-	-	5.9	0.5	8	8	2%	B
2318 HK	Ping An Insurance (H)	China Offshore	Life & Health Insurance	HKD	57.2	54,341	268	5.8%	0.4%	-	5.4	0.8	20	9	3%	B
2020 HK	ANTA Sports	China Offshore	Apparel Accessories & Luxury Goods	HKD	77.8	27,755	79	3.5%	0.5%	10%	11.7	2.5	13	11	3%	B
BEKE UN	KE Holdings (ADR)	China Offshore	Real Estate Services	USD	17.73	19,660	71	1.9%	4.9%	-	13.5	1.8	90	14	9%	B
YUMC UN	Yum China	China Offshore	Restaurants	USD	44.91	15,380	74	2.6%	8.5%	7%	13.4	3.0	17	14	3%	B*
YZJSGD SP	Yangzijiang Shipbuilding	China Offshore	Construction Machinery & Heavy Equipment	SGD	4.86	15,192	56	5.3%	-	7%	8.2	2.6	31	13	15%	B
HTHT UW	H World Group (ADR)	China Offshore	Hotels Resorts & Cruise Lines	USD	47.71	14,782	90	4.4%	2.1%	6%	14.9	7.0	26	18	2%	B
3808 HK	Sinotruk (Hong Kong)	China Offshore	Construction Machinery & Heavy Equipment	HKD	41.58	14,644	55	5.0%	-	5%	10.0	2.0	26	20	8%	B
2319 HK	China Mengniu Dairy	China Offshore	Packaged Foods & Meats	HKD	18.79	9,279	50	3.7%	0.2%	9%	11.2	1.4	143	14	2%	B
2338 HK	Weichai Power (H)	China Offshore	Construction Machinery & Heavy Equipment	HKD	31.6	7,832	87	3.5%	0.3%	7%	12.9	2.3	41	27	9%	B
3998 HK	Bosideng Int'l	China Offshore	Apparel Accessories & Luxury Goods	HKD	4.42	6,610	14	7.5%	0.0%	9%	9.7	2.3	12	8	3%	B
ATAT UW	Atour Lifestyle (ADR)	China Offshore	Hotels Resorts & Cruise Lines	USD	34.69	3,867	39	2.5%	4.0%	7%	12.3	6.8	33	21	4%	B
9896 HK	MINISO Group	China Offshore	Broadline Retail	HKD	21.44	3,320	13	6.8%	-	12%	6.5	1.8	14	14	1%	B
600026 CG	COSCO Shipping Energy Transport. (A)	China A	Oil & Gas Storage & Transportation	CNY	18.61	10,585	240	5.2%	-	10%	10.4	1.9	140	(10)	2%	B
603233 CG	DaShenLin Pharmaceutical (A)	China A	Drug Retail	CNY	17.72	3,003	19	5.2%	-	12%	11.7	2.6	20	16	2%	B
005930 KP	Samsung Electronics	Korea	Technology Hardware Storage & Peripherals	KRW	266000	1,126,402	5,203	2.9%	1.0%	16%	3.8	2.5	621	45	29%	B*
000660 KP	SK Hynix	Korea	Semiconductors	KRW	1730000	915,364	6,244	0.2%	3.8%	17%	3.7	3.3	499	30	22%	B
105560 KP	KB Financial	Korea	Diversified Banks	KRW	168100	43,186	141	2.9%	5.2%	-	8.4	1.0	23	6	4%	B*
055550 KP	Shinhan Financial	Korea	Diversified Banks	KRW	108800	36,996	90	2.7%	3.7%	-	8.2	0.9	26	8	6%	B
000270 KP	Kia	Korea	Automobile Manufacturers	KRW	126100	35,659	128	5.5%	0.7%	20%	5.3	0.7	11	11	2%	B
086790 KP	Hana Financial	Korea	Diversified Banks	KRW	133600	26,550	72	3.5%	3.6%	-	7.4	0.8	19	9	3%	B
030200 KP	KT Corporation	Korea	Integrated Telecommunication Services	KRW	53900	9,839	17	4.5%	3.5%	19%	8.5	0.7	(17)	7	0%	B
PTT TB	PTT Public	Thailand	Integrated Oil & Gas	THB	40.25	34,957	102	5.5%	0.1%	9%	10.6	1.0	30	(7)	5%	B
CPN TB	Central Pattana Public	Thailand	Real Estate Operating Companies	THB	66	9,007	15	3.8%	-	-	14.0	2.5	2	10	1%	B
Median						21,442	73	3.6%	0.9%	7.9%	11.6	1.8	19	10	3.5%	

Note: GS ratings are based on our sector analysts' views: B = Buy; * denotes stocks on the Asia-Pacific Conviction List. Valuations and earnings growth forecasts are based on I/B/E/S estimates. Pricing as of Aug 27, 2026.

Source: FactSet, I/B/E/S, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Timothy Moe, CFA, Alvin So, CFA, John Kwon, Kinger Lau, CFA, Sunil Koul, Bruce Kirk, CFA, Amorita Goel, CFA and Terry Chan, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views, which have not been influenced by considerations of the firm's business or client relationships.

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